

KORE.AI COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Competitive Signal Report

Topic: Enterprise agentic AI & contact-center AI (CCAI) · Window: last 72h · Monday, 24 August 2026 · 20:14 IST
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Bottom line: Competitors are pushing agentic AI capabilities, with Salesforce highlighting significant ARR growth for Agentforce and IBM focusing on its "agentic control plane" for broader enterprise applications. Kore.ai's strength lies in its proven, unified platform and superior analyst validation in the core conversational AI for CX space, allowing us to undercut competitors on platform maturity, predictable TCO, and independent validation.

WHAT MATTERS THIS RUN

Three signals that matter

Salesforce Agentforce Surges Past \$1B ARR

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-08-21) Salesforce Climbs 5% Before Earnings as Agentforce Tops \$1 Billion in Annual Sales. [finance.biggo.com](#) **WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI**
While impressive ARR growth, Salesforce's Agentforce pricing model continues to be a point of friction and unpredictability for customers, a stark contrast to Kore.ai's transparent, outcome-based pricing and ABL's compile-time validation that prevents costly production issues.

IBM Positions watsonx as an "Agentic Control Plane"

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-08-24) IBM and the USTA Introduce New AI-Powered Fan Experiences for 2026 US Open. [Morningstar](#) **WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI**
IBM's focus on a "control plane" acknowledges the need for orchestration but highlights their platform's back-office orientation and a newer, bolt-on approach to contact center AI, whereas Kore.ai offers a unified, purpose-built CX platform with deep voice-native capabilities and proven enterprise-wide adoption.

Salesforce Agentforce Powers US Army Support

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-08-24) Salesforce deploys Agentforce AI for 24/7 US Army HRC support. [Intelligent CIO](#) **WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI**
While Salesforce leverages Agentforce for government contracts, this deployment underscores their reliance on broad platform plays rather than a specialized, CX-native solution. Kore.ai's proven leadership in independent CX conversational AI evaluations and its robust, secure platform provide a more tailored and validated solution for enterprise customer service needs.

AT A GLANCE

Signal priority table

Competitor	Move (dated)	Threat	Kore.ai counter
Agentforce (Salesforce)	(2026-08-21) Salesforce Climbs 5% Before Earnings as Agentforce Tops \$1 Billion in Annual Sales - finance.biggo.com	High	Predictable TCO and compile-time validation vs. credit anxiety/overages
IBM Agent Platform	(2026-08-24) IBM and the USTA Introduce New AI-Powered Fan Experiences for 2026 US Open - Morningstar	Med	Unified, CX-native platform vs. back-office focus and bolt-on CX
Agentforce (Salesforce)	(2026-08-24) Salesforce deploys Agentforce AI for 24/7 US Army HRC support - Intelligent CIO	Med	Proven CX leadership and analyst validation vs. broad platform play
PolyAI	(2026-08-24) PolyAI launches direct Epic integration, PDS Health among 1st to deploy - DrBicuspid.com	Low	True omnichannel and enterprise platform breadth vs. voice-first specialization

ON THE RADAR

Watch for

- Continued analyst validation for Kore.ai and NiCE Cognigy as Leaders in Conversational AI for Customer Service.
- Any further clarification or shifts in Salesforce's Agentforce pricing models.
- IBM's progress in integrating third-party LLMs into watsonx Orchestrate and its impact on CX use cases.

SO WHAT — DO THIS NOW

Recommended actions

- Emphasize Kore.ai's **proven leadership in independent CX conversational AI evaluations** (Gartner, Forrester) to counter competitors' broad platform plays.
- Highlight the **predictability and transparency of Kore.ai's pricing** and TCO compared to consumption-based models like Salesforce's Agentforce.
- Arm Sales with messaging on Kore.ai's **unified, voice-native, and truly omnichannel platform** versus competitors with back-office origins or voice-first limitations.
- Reinforce the **compile-time validation** of ABL as a key differentiator for enterprise-grade reliability and governance, especially against less structured development approaches.

EVIDENCE TRAIL

Sources

- (2026-08-24) PolyAI launches direct Epic integration, PDS Health among 1st to deploy - [DrBicuspid.com](#)
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- (2026-08-24) IBM and the USTA Introduce New AI-Powered Fan Experiences for 2026 US Open - [Morningstar](#)
- (2026-08-22) Salesforce Aims to End the 'Frankenstein' Contact Center With Agentforce - [TechRepublic](#)
- (2026-08-21) Salesforce partners not seeing meaningful revenue from Agentforce AI platform, report says - [The Register](#)
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